MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on CI/CD engineering, ephemeral test-environment design and build tooling, and additional personal Kubernetes, GitOps and Terraform infrastructure work. Experienced with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, and with improving pipeline speed, reliability and observability. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s cluster managed with GitOps and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Currently preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam. Owns CI/CD and test-environment improvements for three product teams, documents internal platform usage for onboarding, and enables QA and product teams to review and test changes in isolated environments. Owns CI/CD and test-environment improvements for three product teams, documents platform usage for onboarding, and mentors junior QA engineers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure engineering and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access), k3s, Argo CD, ephemeral environments, GitOps, observability
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS infrastructure project)
Monitoring, networking and security: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik ingress, cert-manager, TLS certificate management.
Programming and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic)
Cloud learning: AWS free tier (EC2 and S3 basics); no professional cloud-platform experience

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw 2021–Present

- Own and improve GitLab CI/CD pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, plus artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Designed and operated merge-request ephemeral environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster; each environment included the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, with automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review changes and run end-to-end tests in isolated environments before merge.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL pipeline-results collection workflow and Grafana dashboards to identify flaky tests by team.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data.
- Authored the internal guide to CI pipeline usage used in onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.

- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring; configured Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS certificate management in a personal k3s environment.
- Provisioned a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform and used Ansible at a basic level.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health 2023

- Collected GitLab CI test results through the GitLab API into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; helped teams reduce the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | Exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)